

The Cost of Always Being Busy: Pressure Builds

忙碌的代价：压力上升

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The pressure built in the morning, after the club established a new **condition** for the season: every athlete would **give** two hours a week to the open class. "In this shop we do not pay for good health," the manager said. "We build it." The **food** in the canteen changed, the **drug** cabinet was locked, and the **defense** of the old timetable finally collapsed.

The **worry** was the **bird** in the hand: a **pledge** to **play** in the spring, a **meal** plan that attracted nobody, and an **ideal diet** written by somebody who had never been hungry. The **suggestion** of a **bath** and a **basin** of warm water produced a **relief** that no **formula** could. **Immigration**, **infection**, and **consumption** were the three old words on the wall, and nobody in the century had liked them.

The **symptom** that mattered was silence. "A **constitutional** weakness is not a personal failure," the doctor said. "But an **addiction** to busyness is a **complication** of the modern timetable." The **rhythm** of the week, the **outlook** of the committee, and the **humor** of the physiotherapist all had to change together.

"You can **relieve distress** without **torture**," she said. "**Scissors**, a **satellite** image, and a **disciplined** hour of sleep will do more than an **invasion** of advice." The **irrigation** of the pitch, the **ash** in the **basin**, and the **hearty** soup were small mercies, and the team counted them.

The pressure did not come only from management. A **fixation** on numbers, an **adaptation** of the whole club, and the physiology of **digestion** were now part of the programme. "We are able to help," Maya wrote. "We are not able to hurry a body through a century in one season." The window of the sports center stayed open all winter, and the movement of the class went on. There was no **peace** in the canteen, and the **opposition** to the new rule was loud. "The cost is real," the manager said, "and the way we thank the volunteers is by counting them." An **indication** of **diabetes** in one player, a **bank** of tests, and a family history of illness made the argument concrete; the word "bank" came back, and this time nobody laughed at it.

中文翻译

压力在早晨累积起来，此前俱乐部为这个赛季确立了一个新条件：每位运动员每周为公开课贡献两小时。“在这家商店里，我们不为健康付钱，”经理说，“我们把它建起来。”食堂的食物变了，药柜上了锁，而旧时刻表的防线终于崩塌。

担忧就像手里的一只鸟：一份春天参赛的誓言、一份谁都吸引不了的餐食计划，以及一份从未挨过饿的人写出的理想饮食。一次沐浴和一小盆温水的建议，产生了任何公式都带不来的舒缓。移民、传染与痼疾是墙上的三个旧词，而这个世纪里没人喜欢过它们。

真正要紧的症状是沉默。“体质上的虚弱不是个人的失败，”医生说，“但对忙碌的沉迷，是现代时间表的一种并发症。”一周的节奏、委员会的前景，以及理疗师的幽默，都必须一起改变。

“你不必用拷问来缓解苦恼，”她说，“一把剪刀、一张卫星图和一个守纪律的睡眠小时，比一场建议的入侵更有用。”球场的灌溉、盆里的灰烬，以及那锅丰盛的汤，都是小小的慈悲，而团队把它们一一记下。

压力不只来自管理层。对数字的执念、整个俱乐部的适应，以及消化的生理机制，如今都成了项目的一部分。“我们有能力帮忙，”曼雅写道，“但我们没有能力让一具身体在一个赛季里跑完一个世纪。”体育中心的窗户整个冬天都开着，而课程的动作仍在继续。食堂里没有安宁，对新规定的反对声很大。“代价是真实的，”经理说，“而我们感谢志愿者的方式，就是把他们算进去。”一名球员身上糖尿病的迹象、一组化验，以及一段家族病史，让这场论证变得具体；“银行”这个词又回来了，而这一次没有人笑它。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
give ɡɪv POS: n	n. 弹性, 适应性; vt. 给, 授予, 供给, 产生, 发表, 付出, 献出, 让出; vi. 捐赠, 支持不住, 让步 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the elasticity of something that can be stretched and returns to its original length; v. cause to have, in...
play pleɪ POS: n	n. 游戏, 游玩, 玩笑, 运动, 比赛, 赌博, 跳动, 表演, 剧本; v. 玩, 游戏, 假装, 开玩笑, 比赛, 扮演, 演奏, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a dramatic work intended for performance by actors on a stage; n. a theatrical performance of a drama; n. a...
food fu:ɪd POS: n	n. 食物, 养料; [医] 食物, 食品 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any substance that can be metabolized by an animal to give energy and build tissue; n. any solid substance...
condition kən'dɪʃən POS: n	n. 情况, 条件; vt. 使健康, 以...为条件, 决定, 使适应; [计] 条件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state at a particular time; n. an assumption on which rests the validity or effect of something else; n. a...
drug drʌɡ POS: n	n. 药, 麻药, 麻醉药; vi. 吸毒; vt. 使服麻醉药, 使麻木 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a substance that is used as a medicine or narcotic; v. administer a drug to; v. use recreational drugs
defense dɪ'fens POS: n	n. 防卫, 防卫物; [医] 防御 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (military) military action or resources protecting a country against potential enemies; n. protection from...
peace pi:s POS: n	n. 和平, 和约, 治安, 和睦, 安宁, 静寂; vi. 安静下来, 不作声 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state prevailing during the absence of war; n. harmonious relations; freedom from disputes; n. the absence...
worry 'wʌri POS: n	n. 担心, 烦恼, 忧虑, 苦恼, 撕咬; vt. 使烦恼, 使焦虑, 使苦恼, 困扰, 折磨, 撕咬; vi. 烦恼, 担心, 撕咬 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong feeling of anxiety; v. be worried, concerned, anxious, troubled, or uneasy; v. be concerned with; v. ...
bird bɜ:d POS: n	n. 鸟, 羽毛球; vi. 打鸟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. warm-blooded egg-laying vertebrates characterized by feathers and forelimbs modified as wings; n. the flesh...
opposition ,əpe'zɪʃən POS: n	n. 反对, 敌对, 相反, 在野党; [医] 对生, 对向, 反抗, 反对症 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relation between opposed entities; n. a contestant that you are matched against; n. a body of people uni...
relief rɪ'li:f POS: n	n. 减轻, 解除, 救济, 安慰, 调剂, 浮雕, 换班, (地势的)起伏; [医] 缓解, 减轻, 浮雕(绘画中) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the feeling that comes when something burdensome is removed or reduced; n. the condition of being comfortab...
meal mi:l POS: n	n. 一餐, 膳食, 粗粉; vi. 进餐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the food served and eaten at one time; n. any of the occasions for eating food that occur by custom or habi...
attract ə'trækt POS: vt	vt. 吸引, 诱惑; vi. 有吸引力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. direct toward itself or oneself by means of some psychological power or physical attributes; v. be attracti...
suggestion sə'dʒestʃən POS: n	n. 提议, 意见; [医] 暗示 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an idea that is suggested; n. a proposal offered for acceptance or rejection; n. persuasion formulated as a...
ideal aɪ'diəl POS: n	n. 理想, 典范, 观念, 思想, 最后目标; a. 理想的, 完美的, 空想的, 观念的, 唯心论的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the idea of something that is perfect; something that one hopes to attain; n. model of excellence or perfec...
diet 'daɪet POS: n	n. 日常饮食, 议会; vt. 照规定饮食; vi. 忌食 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a prescribed selection of foods; n. a legislative assembly in certain countries (e.g., Japan); n. the usual...
symptom 'sɪmptəm POS: n	n. 症状, 征候, 征兆; [医] 症状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (medicine) any sensation or change in bodily function that is experienced by a patient and is associated w...
immigration ,ɪmɪ'ɡreɪʃən POS: n	n. 移民, 移居; [医] 移民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. migration into a place (especially migration to a country of which you are not a native in order to settle...
infection ɪn'fekʃən POS: n	n. 传染, 影响, 传染病; [医] 传染, 感染 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the pathological state resulting from the invasion of the body by pathogenic microorganisms; n. (phonetics)...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
bath bəθ.bɑ:θ POS: n	n. 沐浴, 浴室; [医] 浴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a vessel containing liquid in which something is immersed (as to process it or to maintain it at a constan...
consumption kən'sʌmpʃən POS: n	n. 消费, 消费量, 痨病; [化] 消耗量; 耗量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the process of taking food into the body through the mouth (as by eating); n. (economics) the utilization o...
formula 'fɔ:mjulə POS: n	n. 客套语, 公式, 准则; [计] 公式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of symbols that make a mathematical statement; n. a conventionalized statement expressing some fund...
satellite 'sætlait POS: n	n. 人造卫星; [医] 伴行静脉, 陪静脉, 陪病部, 随体, 卫星 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. man-made equipment that orbits around the earth or the moon; n. a person who follows or serves another; n. a...
indication ,indi'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 指示, 象征, 暗示; [医] 指示, 指征, 适应征 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that serves to indicate or suggest; n. the act of indicating or pointing out by name; n. (medicine)...
constitutional ,konsti'tju:ʃənəl POS: a	a. 宪法的, 立宪的, 体质的; [医] 全身的; 体质的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a regular walk taken as a form of exercise; a. of benefit to or intended to benefit your physical makeup; a. ...
humor 'hju:mə POS: n	n. 幽默, 诙谐, 心情; vt. 迎合, 牵就, 顺应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the trait of appreciating (and being able to express) the humorous; n. the quality of being funny; n. (Middl...
rhythm 'riðəm POS: n	n. 旋律, 节奏, 韵律, 匀称, 张弛节律; [医] 节律 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the basic rhythmic unit in a piece of music; n. recurring at regular intervals; n. the arrangement of spoken...
invasion in'veɪʒən POS: n	n. 侵犯, 侵入, 侵害; [医] 侵袭, 侵入, 发病 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of invading; the act of an army that invades for conquest or plunder; n. any entry into an area not...
relieve ri'li:v POS: vt	vt. 减轻, 救济, 解除, 使免除, 换...的班, 使得到调剂, 使不单调, 衬托, 使显著; vi. 救济, 当替补投手, 呈鲜明突出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. provide physical relief, as from pain; v. free from a burden, evil, or distress; v. take by stealing; v. alle...
diabetes daɪə'bi:tɪz POS: n	n. 糖尿病, 多尿症; [医] 糖尿病; 多尿症 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a polygenic disease characterized by abnormally high glucose levels in the blood; any of several metabolic...
distress di'stres POS: n	n. 苦恼, 贫困, 痛苦; vt. 使苦恼; a. 亏本出售的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. psychological suffering; n. a state of adversity (danger or affliction or need); n. extreme physical pain; n. ...
basin 'beɪsn POS: n	n. 盆, 盆地; [医] 第三脑室, 骨盆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a bowl-shaped vessel; usually used for holding food or liquids; n. the quantity that a basin will hold; n. a...
ash æʃ POS: n	n. 灰, 灰烬; [化] 灰分 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the residue that remains when something is burned; n. any of various deciduous pinnate-leaved ornamental or...
complication ,kompli'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 复杂化, 复杂情况; [医] 并发症, 并发病 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act or process of complicating; n. a situation or condition that is complex or confused; n. any disease...
outlook 'aʊtlʊk POS: n	n. 观点, 景色, 前途, 了望; [经] 展望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a habitual or characteristic mental attitude that determines how you will interpret and respond to situatio...
addiction ə'dɪkʃən POS: n	n. 入迷, 瘾; [医] 瘾, 癖嗜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. being abnormally tolerant to and dependent on something that is psychologically or physically habit-formin...
adaptation ,ædæp'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 适应, 改编, 改编本; [医] 适应[作用] Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written work (as a novel) that has been recast in a new form; n. the process of adapting to something (su...
pledge pledʒ POS: n	n. 诺言, 保证, 誓言, 抵押, 信物, 保人, 祝愿; vt. 许诺, 保证, 使发誓, 抵押, 典当, 举杯祝...健康 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a deposit of personal property as security for a debt; n. someone accepted for membership but not yet fully...
torture 'tɔ:tʃə POS: n	n. 拷问, 苦闷; vt. 拷问, 曲解, 折磨, 使弯曲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. unbearable physical pain; n. the deliberate, systematic, or wanton infliction of physical or mental sufferi...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
irrigation 'iri'geiʃən POS: n	n. 灌溉, 冲洗; [医] 冲洗法, 灌溉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. supplying dry land with water by means of ditches etc; n. (medicine) cleaning a wound or body organ by flus...
scissors 'sizez POS: review required	pl. 剪刀; [医] 剪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an edge tool having two crossed pivoting blades; n. a wrestling hold in which you wrap your legs around the...
digestion di'dʒestʃən POS: n	n. 消化力, 领悟; [化] 消化: 消化作用; 蒸煮: 蒸煮作用; 煮解: 浸提; 陈化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the process of decomposing organic matter (as in sewage) by bacteria or by chemical action or heat; n. the...
hearty 'hɑ:ti POS: a	a. 诚恳的, 健壮的, 热烈的, 丰盛的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. showing warm and heartfelt friendliness; s. providing abundant nourishment; s. endowed with or exhibiting gr...
disciplined 'disiplind POS: a	a. 遵守纪律的; 受过训练的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. obeying the rules; s. trained mentally or physically by instruction or exercise
fixation fik'seɪʃən POS: n	n. 定置, 固定, 定色; [医] 固定; 固定法, 固定术; 定影 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of fastening something firmly in position; n. (histology) the preservation and hardening of a...